Obed Mathias Gaiya

Senior Full-Stack Engineer · React, Node.js, Java

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Summary

Senior full-stack engineer with 8+ years building web, mobile, and backend systems end to end. Delivers React and Next.js frontends, React Native and Flutter apps, and scalable Node.js and Java backends. Scaled WorkNation's platform to 100K+ requests per second at 99.9% uptime and led its backend and frontend microservices migration. Recent depth in fintech across Nigeria and the UAE: wallets, lending, payments, and open banking.

Highlights

- **End-to-end delivery:** Took products from concept to production across frontend, backend, and mobile, on schedule.
- **Scale and performance:** 100K+ requests per second at 99.9% uptime; 40% faster API responses through caching.
- **Web and mobile:** React and Next.js web apps, React Native and Flutter mobile apps, and open-source payment SDKs for both.
- **Integrations:** Stripe, banking and open banking APIs, accounting platforms, WhatsApp (Infobip), and UAE PASS digital identity.
- **Leadership:** Code review standards that cut defects by 30%; mentoring engineers; former lead instructor.

Core skills

- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, Vue.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, responsive UI, reusable component design
- **Mobile:** React Native, Flutter
- **Backend:** Node.js (NestJS, Express, AdonisJS), Java, Spring Boot, PHP (Laravel), REST APIs, WebSockets
- **Architecture:** distributed systems, microservices, event-driven design, caching, system design
- **Data and DevOps:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Jest, Mocha
- **Domains:** fintech and payments, HR and payroll SaaS, future-of-work platforms

Professional experience

Software Engineer (Contract) — DigiSpray LLC

Lagos, Nigeria · 2025 – Present

- Leading the rebuild and architectural refactoring of the web and mobile platform, improving scalability and maintainability.
- Building a real-time digital money-spraying platform for events, from wallet top-ups and gifting flows to bank withdrawals.
- Designed the backend to handle bursts of simultaneous transactions at live events, using idempotency keys, verified webhooks, and reconciliation.

Software Engineer (Contract) — Zuka Solutions Limited

Nigeria · 2024 – 2025

- Built Zuka, a WhatsApp money assistant for balances, activity, transfers, and payments through chat.
- Built conversational review-and-approve transaction flows and status tracking that prevents duplicate actions.
- Built secure identity verification and onboarding through purpose-built forms outside the chat.

Senior Software Engineer (Contract) — FracXn

Dubai, UAE · 2024 – 2025

- Built backend services and responsive React and Next.js frontends for loan apps, payroll, invoice financing, and instant settlements.
- Built a risk scoring service for lenders, and integrated Lean Technologies open banking, Emirates NBD, and Stripe.
- Integrated QuickBooks, Zoho Books, and Wafeq, built OCR document extraction, and implemented UAE PASS SSO.

Lead Software Engineer (Contract) — Juice Technology

Lagos, Nigeria · 2023 – 2024

- Led system design for an HR and payroll SaaS platform and built Laravel Nova admin dashboards.
- Built a NestJS wallet service for Juiceme and connected WhatsApp chatbots to the backend through Infobip.

Lead Software Engineer (Full Time) — Outsource Global (WorkNation)

Abuja, Nigeria · 2021 – 2025

- Scaled the WorkNation platform to 100K+ requests per second at 99.9% uptime.
- Re-engineered both backend and frontend into a microservices architecture, improving reliability and deployment speed, and cut API response times by 40% with caching.
- Built a coding challenge platform that made technical hiring 60% more efficient, plus career and skills assessment tools.
- Set code review standards that reduced defects by 30%, mentored engineers, and delivered multiple projects from concept to production.

Software Engineer (Contract) — Afropolis

2020 – 2021

- Built RESTful APIs in Laravel and Node.js, real-time features with WebSockets, and reusable components in React, Vue.js, and React Native.

Earlier experience

- **Software Engineer and Lead Instructor (Contract), Tribesquare Inc.** · 2021
- **Software Engineering Instructor, Campus Technologies (NIIT)** · 2019 – 2021
- **Junior Software Engineer, Ogohtech Computers** · 2017 – 2018

Open source

- **Fincra Checkout SDKs** — Production-ready React Native (TypeScript) and Flutter SDKs for Fincra Checkout payments · github.com/gaiyadev/react-native-fincra-checkout · pub.dev/packages/flutter_fincra_checkout
- **nestjs-drizzle-orm** — NestJS module for Drizzle ORM (PostgreSQL, MySQL) · npmjs.com/package/nestjs-drizzle-orm

Education and certifications

- **B.Sc. Mathematics**, Kaduna State University · 2012 – 2017
- Postgraduate Diploma, Project Management
- Software Architecture (Udemy, 2022) · DevOps (Udemy)